Choose the data home and the application operator

Three operating models for one Nexus portal. Around 1,000 users: field teams, office teams and authorised client viewers.

01 CATALYST HOLDS THE DATA

Continuity option

Retailer sales + inventory

↓

Catalyst extraction + supplier data

Existing service; exact hosting unconfirmed

↓

Meridian integrates Nexus

Carin's handover still needs integration

BENEFIT

Retain current feeds and supplier knowledge; avoid an immediate data cutover.

TRADE-OFF

API/export limits and supplier dependency remain. The quoted retainer is not a complete Nexus integration service.

02 GEO REP HOLDS THE DATA

Managed integration option

Retailer feeds + Geo field data

↓

Geo Rep data + integration services

Proposed AWS model; scope and quote needed

↓

Geo integrates + hosts one Nexus

Carin's scripts + current Nexus capabilities

BENEFIT

Potentially one accountable integration and hosting partner, aligned with field operations.

TRADE-OFF

Data, hosting and field services concentrate in one supplier. Firebase migration and retailer ETL must be priced and proven.

03 MERIDIAN HOLDS THE DATA

Recommended strategic destination

Authorised supplier feeds + files

↓

Meridian lake on Google Cloud

Johannesburg | Meridian-controlled account

↓

Meridian integrates + hosts Nexus

Continue the existing Firebase integration

BENEFIT

Reuse Nexus work; control data access and priorities for mobile, AI and client reporting.

TRADE-OFF

Meridian owns integration, security and support obligations. A cloud bill does not fund the people or replace retailer extraction.

Carin's handover is a product integration programme

Require the same complete acceptance scope from Geo Rep and the in-house team. Moving HTML files alone does not complete it.

WORKSTREAM	WHAT MUST WORK IN ONE NEXUS	COST / MIGRATION IMPLICATION
Insights + inventory	All source tabs, filters, charts, drilldowns and exports; verified retail sales and inventory totals.	Keep proven calculations. Inventory every sales/DuckDB query and data source before changing storage.
Stock Fix end to end	Inventory refresh, roster import, task generation, field capture and reporting; durable job status.	H2 describes separate operational Postgres and reporting DuckDB. Migrating one does not migrate both.
Call Cycle + attendance	Master building, coverage, hierarchy, approvals, refresh jobs and rep/merchandiser attendance.	H1 describes a manual three-file master build. Preserve human review; automatic extraction is separate scope.
One application shell	One sign-in, Nexus sidebar, consistent roles, client isolation, deep links and mobile layouts.	Geo must price Firebase auth, database/rules, files, functions and current chat/tasks/notifications parity.
Production operations	Scheduled jobs, retries, audit logs, rollback, alerts, secrets, backups and a named support owner.	H2 reports jobs lasting 55-75 minutes. Use durable workers, not long browser requests or laptop processes.

GEO REP: QUOTE THE WHOLE HANDOVER

Discovery + code integration + any AWS replatforming + data transfer + parallel testing + training + ongoing support. Separate one-off and recurring fees.

MERIDIAN: COST THE REMAINING WORK

Reuse Firebase. Integration cost = remaining engineering/test days x approved internal rate, plus operating cover. Existing staff time is not free.

Acceptance: source-design parity + reconciled data + all workflows in one portal, not separate embedded applications.

Compare the costs without hiding integration effort

Catalyst: supplier email. Geo Rep: no quote. Meridian: Google Cloud infrastructure allowance only, not a total project price.

CATALYST | QUOTED

R25,000 / month

Retainer: 2-4 days expected effort; operations, fixes and some small changes. Reviewed periodically.

R60,000 once-off, excl VAT

API: 5-8 workdays; full raw history/export not confirmed. Nexus configuration excluded.

GEO REP | QUOTE REQUIRED

Not yet priced

Request a fixed scope for integrating Carin + Nexus, retailer ETL, data migration and hosting.

Separate monthly charges

Hosting, support/SLA, API and field licences; identify overlap with current Geo fees.

MERIDIAN | CLOUD ONLY

R6,000-15,000 / month

Indicative infrastructure budget; R72,000-180,000 per year at the same usage. Excludes VAT.

Integration is additional effort

Existing staff capacity, not free work. Finance must value the remaining backlog and support cover.

FIRST-YEAR COMPARISON: NO CLAIM OF SAVINGS

Catalyst: R300k retainer; R360k with API.*
Meridian lake + Catalyst kept for 12 months + API: R432k-540k, before other excluded costs.*

*Assumes the R25k retainer is ex VAT (not stated in email), unchanged for 12 months; API purchased once. Confirm tax, hosting inclusions and outstanding project fees.

Meridian excludes labour, migration, paid support, source/API fees, AI/IR, WhatsApp, devices and regional-disaster failover. These are not zero-cost items.

GOOGLE CLOUD: MONTHLY PLANNING ALLOWANCES

Lake files, history and backup storage	R600-R1 500
BigQuery storage and analytical queries	R1 000-R3 000
APIs, ETL jobs and operational data	R1 800-R4 000
Logs, secrets and security services	R600-R1 500
Network, serving and fixed outbound IP	R1 000-R2 500

Subtotal R5,000-12,500 + 20% reserve = R6,000-15,000

Planning range, not a regional quote. Validate page-5 sizing with actual usage.

Risk follows control, evidence and operating capacity

Provisional pre-control exposure, not an audit or provider score. H = material gap / decision gate; M = manageable exposure requiring evidence.

RISK	CATALYST	GEO REP	MERIDIAN	CONTROL / ACCOUNTABLE OWNER
Feed / ETL continuity	M | existing feeds	H | new pipeline	H | new imports	Parallel daily + monthly reconciliation; preserve source rights. BI + integration lead.
Handover / parity	H | not in quote	H | scope unpriced	M | reuse, then test	Module register; one-portal regression and field workflow tests. Software & AI lead.
Data / IP lock-in	H | export unclear	H | concentrated	M | direct control	Raw/history export rights; code assignments; tested exit. Legal + executive sponsor.
Security / privacy	H | unverified	H | unverified	H | configuration	Admin MFA, client isolation, secret rotation, operator agreements. IT + Information Officer.
Outage / recovery	H | SLA unmeasured	H | SLA unknown	H | single region	Restore proof, recovery targets and region-outage response. IT + service operator.
Support / key person	M | retainer limits	H | combined reliance	H | staff dependence	Named deputy, incident cover, release controls and runbooks. Delivery owner.
Freshness / cost drift	M | reviewable fee	H | quote + tests due	M | usage exposure	Freshness/latency tests, spend monitoring, quotas and price scope. BI + Finance.

OWNERSHIP IS A CONTRACT + CONTROL, NOT A HOSTING LABEL

Meridian-controlled billing, repositories and recovery access; written rights to custom code, historical data, mappings and exports. Supplier and open-source IP remains subject to its licence.

SECURITY GATES APPLY TO ALL THREE

Read-only APIs can still leak data. Keep keys server-side; review AI-generated code and enforce user-scoped AI access. Hosting in JHB is not a POPIA guarantee.

Residual risks must be re-rated after evidence. Local backups do not eliminate a Johannesburg-wide outage.

Build Meridian ownership in controlled stages

Recommendation: keep useful supplier feeds, retain one Nexus app, and make the Meridian-owned lake the strategic destination.

MERIDIAN GOOGLE CLOUD | JOHANNESBURG: africa-south1

Incoming: authorised Catalyst / Geo feeds + retailer files + masters



Nexus APIs + dashboards | Firestore: operational data, not the data lake

Google operates infrastructure; Meridian controls the account, data access and application.

JOHANNESBURG, IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

A controlled library of raw and cleaned data, stored in the selected Johannesburg cloud region. No office server is needed.

Lake storage, analytics and workers are region-bound. Sign-in, delivery networks and external APIs/AI need separate location reviews.

Keep proven calculations during relocation. Change queries/storage only after parity tests. BigQuery is a proposed target, not a completed rewrite.

INDICATIVE PLAN AFTER APPROVAL + ACCESS

Weeks 1-2	Inventory Carin + Nexus; confirm data rights, quotations, backlog and cloud sizing.
Weeks 3-4	Secure JHB foundation; first authorised feed and one end-to-end module pilot.
Weeks 5-8	Integrate agreed modules; compare daily/monthly totals, jobs, exports and roles.
Weeks 9-12	Controlled rollout only after restore, parity and support acceptance; retain rollback.

APPROVE NOW / RELEASE LATER

Approve discovery and Meridian ownership. Get a comparable Geo quote and firm Catalyst API acceptance terms before committing the full programme.

No internal cover? Keep Catalyst while procuring managed support. Do not switch off a feed until two complete reporting cycles reconcile and business owners sign off.

Cloud sizing assumption: 0.5-2 TiB files incl. backups; 0.1-0.5 TiB analytical tables; 5-20 TiB scans/month; daily feeds; 100 concurrent users.
Not measured demand or a delivery promise. All-script scope, full retailer replacement, mobile ordering, IR and WhatsApp need separate estimates.